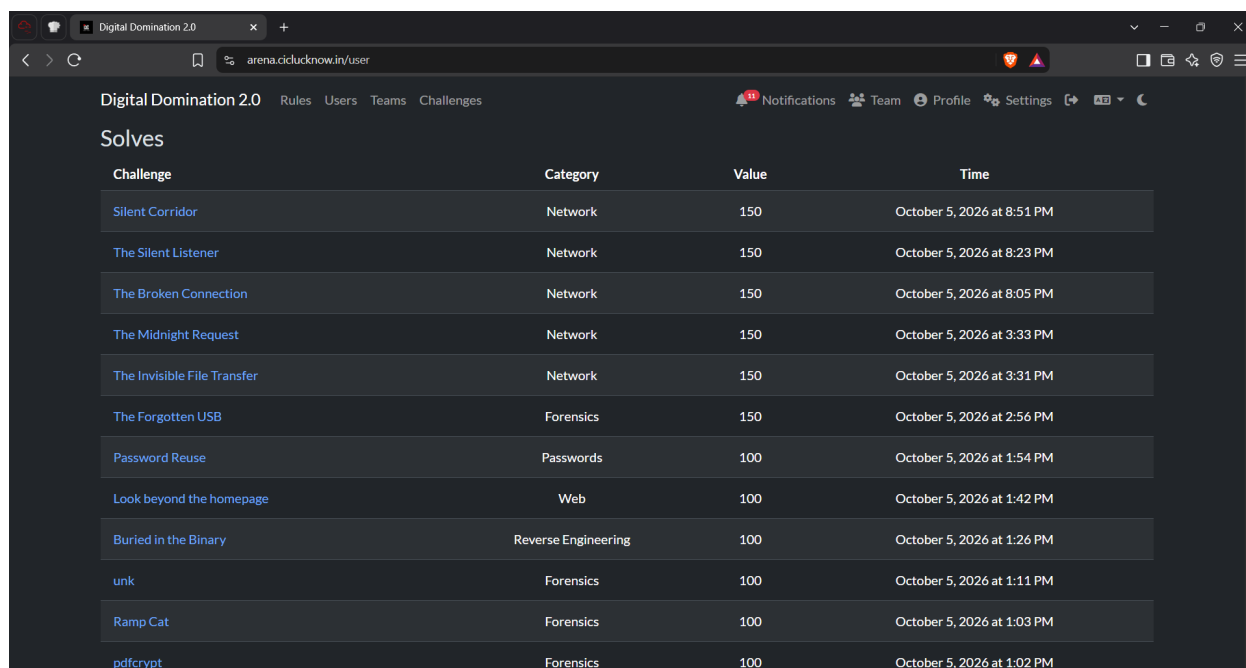


Digital Domination 2.0

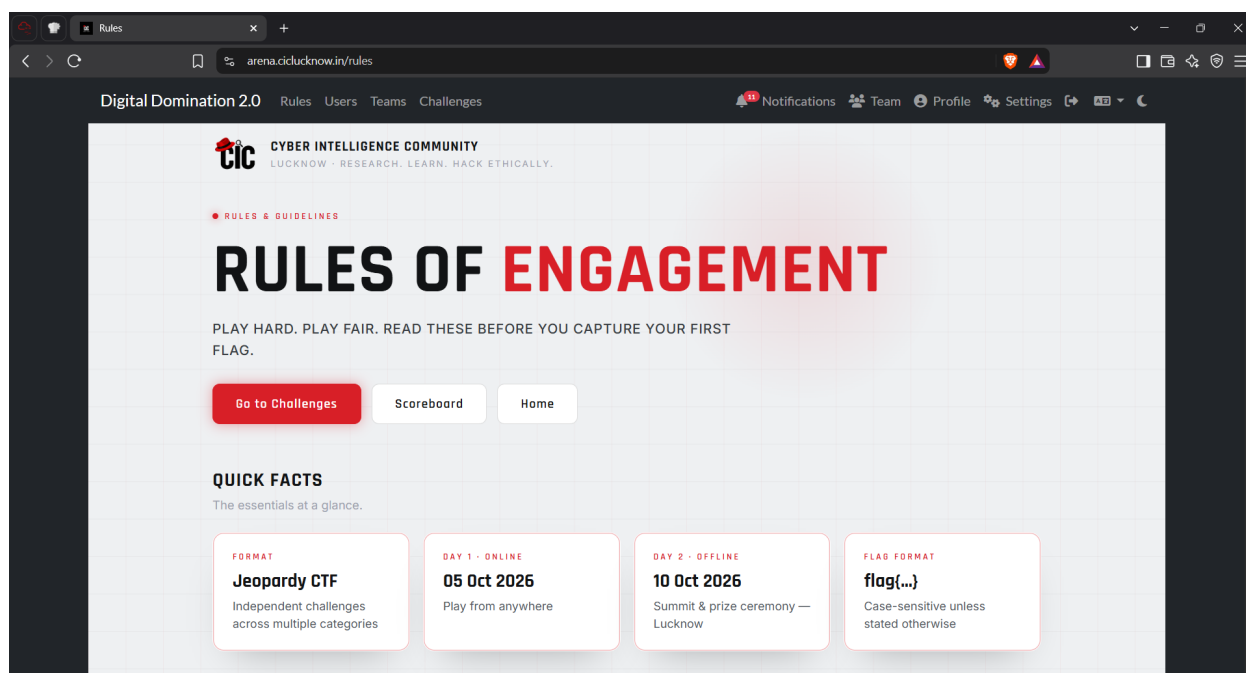
CTF Write-up Summary | Cyber Intelligence Community, Lucknow

I took part in **Digital Domination 2.0**, a Jeopardy-style Capture The Flag event hosted by the **Cyber Intelligence Community (CIC), Lucknow** — "Research. Learn. Hack ethically." The event ran online on Day 1 (5 Oct 2026) with challenges spanning Network Forensics, Disk/File Forensics, Reverse Engineering, Web, Passwords, and Log Analysis.



Challenge	Category	Value	Time
Silent Corridor	Network	150	October 5, 2026 at 8:51 PM
The Silent Listener	Network	150	October 5, 2026 at 8:23 PM
The Broken Connection	Network	150	October 5, 2026 at 8:05 PM
The Midnight Request	Network	150	October 5, 2026 at 3:33 PM
The Invisible File Transfer	Network	150	October 5, 2026 at 3:31 PM
The Forgotten USB	Forensics	150	October 5, 2026 at 2:56 PM
Password Reuse	Passwords	100	October 5, 2026 at 1:54 PM
Look beyond the homepage	Web	100	October 5, 2026 at 1:42 PM
Buried in the Binary	Reverse Engineering	100	October 5, 2026 at 1:26 PM
unk	Forensics	100	October 5, 2026 at 1:11 PM
Ramp Cat	Forensics	100	October 5, 2026 at 1:03 PM
pdfcrypt	Forensics	100	October 5, 2026 at 1:02 PM

My confirmed solves on the official platform (arena.ciclucknow.in) — challenge, category, points, and timestamp.



CYCBER INTELLIGENCE COMMUNITY
LUCKNOW · RESEARCH · LEARN · HACK ETHICALLY.

• RULES & GUIDELINES

RULES OF ENGAGEMENT

PLAY HARD. PLAY FAIR. READ THESE BEFORE YOU CAPTURE YOUR FIRST FLAG.

[Go to Challenges](#) [Scoreboard](#) [Home](#)

QUICK FACTS
The essentials at a glance.

FORMAT Jeopardy CTF Independent challenges across multiple categories	DAY 1 · ONLINE 05 Oct 2026 Play from anywhere	DAY 2 · OFFLINE 10 Oct 2026 Summit & prize ceremony — Lucknow	FLAG FORMAT flag{...} Case-sensitive unless stated otherwise
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Event rules: Jeopardy CTF format, independent challenges across categories, flag format flag{...}, case-sensitive.

Solve Summary

Challenge	Category	Points
Silent Corridor	Network	150
The Silent Listener	Network	150
The Broken Connection	Network	150
The Midnight Request	Network	150
The Invisible File Transfer	Network	150
The Forgotten USB	Forensics	150
Password Reuse	Passwords	100
Look Beyond the Homepage	Web	100
Buried in the Binary	Reverse Engineering	100
unk	Forensics	100
Ramp Cat	Forensics	100
pdfcrypt	Forensics	100
lost flash drive	Forensics	100

Total: 13 challenges solved across Network, Forensics, Reverse Engineering, Web, and Passwords (1,600 points), as recorded on the official scoreboard. Methodology write-ups below are included only for challenges where the steps actually taken were documented.

Technical Write-ups

Every solved challenge below is listed with a status tag describing the basis for its write-up: **Steps Followed** (own commands/output documented), **Technique Summary** (flag confirmed on the scoreboard; general method described, not a personal command log), or **Pending** (solved on the scoreboard; process not yet documented).

The Invisible File Transfer (Network · 150 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Separated normal ICMP ping padding from anomalous ICMP payloads in the capture.
- Found heartbeat-style packets carrying chunked hex data; reassembled by sequence number into a reference string.
- Found larger "diagnostic" ICMP packets carrying a base64-encoded blob.
- Decoded the blob and XORed it with the reference string (stripped of formatting) to recover the flag.

flag{invisible_icmp_227673ac}

Takeaway: Classic covert channel: payload tunneled inside ICMP echo traffic disguised as heartbeat/diagnostic messages.

The Midnight Request (Network · 150 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Filtered out routine traffic (DNS, OCSP, CDN) to isolate one suspicious host impersonating a monitoring service.
- Identified a device-registration POST, followed by a server-issued correlation reference.
- Followed a manifest request using the same correlation ID; decoded the base64 response to reveal the flag.

flag{midnight_request_9bb5d42e}

Takeaway: Correlation IDs are the thread that ties a multi-step HTTP exchange together — follow the ID, not just the host.

The Broken Connection (Network · 150 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Cross-referenced host inventory, firewall log, and DNS log to identify the workstation involved.
- Matched firewall entries to TCP streams in the packet capture by timing and source port.
- Followed a two-step HTTP "update" request chain linked by a ticket ID to decode the flag.

flag{follow_the_evidence_2f629bed}

Takeaway: Multi-source evidence (logs + pcap) is solved by timeline correlation, not any single file.

The Silent Listener (Network · 150 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Filtered a noisy capture of 11 decoy hosts generating routine traffic.
- Isolated a single host that appeared only once, uploading a ZIP archive over HTTP.
- Cracked the archive's password via wordlist attack and recovered the flag from the protected entry.

flag{http_exfiltration_detected}

Takeaway: In noisy captures, the host or packet that breaks the pattern is usually the signal.

The Forgotten USB (Forensics · 150 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Located a 7zAES-encrypted archive on a disk image with readable file names but locked contents.
- Recovered deleted artifacts by inode (a personal note and an internal naming-convention document).
- Reconstructed the archive password from the documented naming pattern, combining a project codename, asset tag, and fiscal quarter.
- Cracked the hash with John using the reconstructed candidate and extracted the flag from the archive.

Flag confirmed accepted on the official scoreboard; exact flag text not retained in this record.

Takeaway: Passwords are rarely written down directly in forensics challenges — they're reconstructed from policy artifacts.

Buried in the Binary (Reverse Engineering · 100 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Pulled every image reference from the target page's HTML and separated external CDN images from the one locally hosted image.
- Downloaded the local image and inspected its EXIF metadata, finding a User Comment pointing to a second filename on the server.
- Located and retrieved that second file, then re-ran EXIF/strings analysis to recover the flag embedded in its metadata.

Flag confirmed accepted on the official scoreboard; exact flag text not retained in this record.

Takeaway: A metadata field can point to a second hidden file rather than contain the flag directly — filtering local vs. external assets first narrows the search fast.

Password Reuse (Passwords · 100 pts) [Steps Followed]

- Cross-referenced a legacy disabled-account list against a current credential dump to isolate 5 password-reuse candidates.
- Cracked all MD5 hashes in the dump in one pass with John and a wordlist attack.
- Tested each reuse candidate's cracked password against an encrypted backup PDF until one successfully decrypted it, revealing the flag.

Flag confirmed accepted on the official scoreboard; exact flag text not retained in this record.

Takeaway: The real vulnerability being tested was credential reuse across a decommissioned and a live system, not the hash cracking itself.

lost flash drive (Forensics · 100 pts) [Technique Summary]

- Identified that the provided archive contained a raw disk image rather than a plain file.
- Used file-identification and carving/filesystem tools to recover a credentials file embedded in the image.

flag{its_adventure_time_yee_boi!!!}

Takeaway: Flag confirmed on the scoreboard; general disk-carving technique described, not a first-hand command log.

unk (Forensics · 100 pts) [Technique Summary]

- Recognized that an extension-less file was actually a ZIP archive (the native format of a .docx).
- Extracted it to expose the standard Word document structure and recovered the flag from the document thumbnail / XML content.

flag{old_macdonald_or_mcdonalds_supplier}

Takeaway: Flag confirmed on the scoreboard; general file-format technique described, not a first-hand command log.

Ramp Cat (Forensics · 100 pts) [Technique Summary]

- Extracted GPS coordinates from the provided image's EXIF metadata.
- Converted the coordinates to decimal degrees and resolved them to a specific point of interest at that location.

flag{Koneko}

Takeaway: Flag confirmed on the scoreboard; general EXIF/geolocation technique described, not a first-hand command log.